

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

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The Hearth's chicken, lounging on the deck beneath gathering clouds.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

77° / 60°

Cloudy

Sunrise 6:17 AM · Sunset 6:14 PM

Tomorrow — Showers, 63/55

AROUND THE HOLD · THE WEEK AHEAD

Fairs and Revelry Fill the Holds as October Nears



By the Dude — Payson, Ariz.



Jousting, market stalls, and festival banners — October's fairs gather beneath the Rim.

PAYSON — Hail, wayfarer! The pines stand grey and grand beneath a cloudy sky, and the fair-wagons are rolling into the Holds. This very afternoon a free Gypsy-

jazz concert fills a Payson church, Sedona's year-round farmers market hums with music and produce, and an arts show spreads its colors at Sedona Vista Village.

Then the week turns to festival: the Northern Gila County Fair takes the Payson Event Center October 1–3, the inaugural North Inch Renaissance Faire jousts into town October 2–4, Pine throws its Fall Festival on October 3, and Prescott answers with a studio tour and a night of nouveau-flamenco guitar. Pack a cloak, traveler — October comes merry to Rim Country.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

-  **Payson**
 - **Free Jazz Concert with Zazu West** — free Gypsy-jazz concert in the Django Reinhardt style, 2:00 PM, Mount Cross Lutheran Church, 601 E Highway 260.
-  **Sedona**
 - **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — weekly year-round market with local produce, artisan goods, and live music from Tobie LaVoie and Friends, 8:00 AM–12:00 PM, Wells Fargo parking lot, 2201 W SR 89A, West Sedona.
 - **Oak Creek Arts & Crafts Show at Sedona Vista Village** — fine art, crafts, Native American art, food booths, and live music with free admission, 9:00 AM–5:00 PM (final day), 6657 AZ-179.
-  **Prescott**
 - **Karaoke at Matt's Saloon** — the weekly karaoke night on Whiskey Row, 7:00 PM, 112 S Montezuma St.

THE DAYS AHEAD

- **Monday, Sept. 28**
 - **Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose**, Pine — the weekly open mic (2nd & 4th Mondays) hosted by the PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction team; tips benefit fuel-reduction work, 4:00–7:00 PM at THAT Brewery & Pub, 3270 AZ-87. Bring a song, leave a coin for the forest.

- **Tuesday, Sept. 29**

- **Trail Day Volunteer Build**, Pine — roll up your sleeves with the PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew: clear brush, move rocks, shape trail; no experience needed and tools provided, 7:00 AM–12:00 PM, off Highway 87 just before Pine (email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions).
- **Happy Fall Y'all Art Show**, Show Low — the City of Show Low Parks & Rec hangs local artists' canvases from its fall art contest in the newly renovated Recreation Building; winners revealed, light refreshments, 5:00–7:30 PM, City Campus Recreation Building C, 760 E McNeil.

- **Thursday, Oct. 1 – Saturday, Oct. 3**

- **Northern Gila County Fair**, Payson — three full days of county-fair merriment at the Payson Event Center; gates open 9:00 AM Thursday and the revels run until 10:00 PM Saturday. The organizers are still posting the lineup of events, so watch their page — this one moved off Globe's fair dates and promises to be the Hold's own.

- **Friday, Oct. 2 – Sunday, Oct. 4**

- **North Inch Renaissance Faire, Pyrate & Faerie Festival**, Payson — the inaugural Scottish-themed renaissance faire rides into town with jousting, merchants, music, and faerie revelry, 9:00 AM–5:00 PM daily, 1504 W Country Club Drive. Don thy finest cloak and come thirsty for adventure.
- **Prescott Area Artist Studio Tour**, Prescott & Quad Cities — a free self-guided ramble through 74 artists across 52 private studios plus three art centers (Mountain Artists Guild, Phippen Museum, 'Tis Annex), with live demonstrations and artwork for sale, 10:00 AM–4:00 PM daily. The muses are out in force.

- **Saturday, Oct. 3**

- **Fall Festival in Pine** — the Pine Strawberry Business Community's autumn gathering with some 70 vendors of crafts and food booths and free admission, 8:00 AM–5:00 PM at the Pine-Strawberry Community Center Ramada, 3886 N Highway 87. Come hungry, leave laden.
 - **Ottmar Liebert & Luna Negra**, Prescott — the Grammy-nominated nouveau-flamenco guitarist brings his tour to the historic Elks Theatre, 7:00 PM. A night of strings to close the week in style.
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QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — A day past its due date — the sconces still await their design, and the forge grows restless. Sketch it out today.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Saturday — once the design is done, let the printer sing its song of layers.

The sconces tarried a day past their due — finish the design, then print by Saturday, and the Hearth's torches take their place upon the walls!



Torches, sconces, doors, and a shield — the workshop hums with Hearthcraft.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Rim Country Recreation Rentals · Payson



Choosing a 'longship' at the water's edge — the outfitter's fleet awaits.

Rim Country Recreation Rentals is Payson's friendly outfitter for everything that floats, rolls, or gets you to the water: single and double kayaks, paddleboards, canoes, pedal boats, mountain bikes, and camping and fishing gear. Every rental runs a full 24 hours — not a stingy few — and pickup in Payson is easy, so you can be skimming across Willow Springs Lake or Blue Ridge Reservoir by midday. Family-owned and run by Michelle, whom reviewers praise by name for her kindness, her local water wisdom, and her last-minute rescues — and her pup Meg greets the customers.

“The entire rental process was simple, fast, and stress-free... This is definitely the go-to spot for kayak rentals near Payson. I'll absolutely be renting from her again for future Arizona trips.” —
[TripAdvisor review](#)

1400 W Red Baron Rd,
Payson, AZ 85541 · Open daily
6:00 AM–9:00 PM · (928)
978-2050 · Fair prices, say the
reviewers · Good to know:
reserve by text or call —
directions to their location
come with the booking — and
gear rents for a full 24 hours;
veteran- and women-owned. ·
[their website](#)

Why the Hearth sends you:

The Rim's high lakes are the Hearth's true waterfront, and no one fits a traveler with a longship like Michelle does — paddle out, wayfarer!

JETHRO SOUNDS THE MORNING HORN



Jethro's echo concert — Earl conducts, Henny lays the mighty cluck.

At sunrise Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) discovered that the Hearth's front deck has a magnificent echo. He meant only to practice his innkeeper's greeting — 'HAAAIL, TRAVELERS!' — but the deck flung it back twice as grand, and a monster does not let a challenge like that go unanswered.

By the third HAAAIL, Earl (an elk) came trotting round the corner to lodge a formal complaint — and got walloped by his own returning dignity. His antlers rang like chapel bells. Earl, being Earl, declared the sound 'music,' snatched up a twig, and began to conduct.

Henny (the Hearth's chicken) surveyed the whole operation, marched to the center of the deck, and laid the finest, loudest cluck of her career — which echoed back so enormous she looked genuinely surprised at herself. Mabel (the wood elf) poked her head out of the herb garden, sighed her professional sigh, and went back to her weeding. The neighbors swear she was tapping her foot.

Jethro has declared the deck concert a morning tradition, to wake the travelers gentle. The guests have not complained yet. The echo has.